RRB NTPC & SSC CGL High-Yield Predictor Master Bank

Focus Area: Tricky Conceptual, Administration Mechanics & Recent 2025 Actual Trends (Mughal & Deccan Kingdoms)

Part 1: Tricky Conceptual & Administration Mechanics

Question 1: The Nuance of Mughal Military Mechanics

Consider the following statements regarding the modifications made to the Mansabdari system under the later Mughal Emperors:
1. The *Du-Aspah Sih-Aspah* system, introduced by Jahangir, allowed the state to double a noble's military obligations (Sawar) without altering their base status rank (Zat).
2. The Month-Scale (Shash-Maha) system, introduced by Shah Jahan, was designed to shorten the mandatory annual training duration of imperial cavalrymen.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(A) Only 1
(B) Only 2
(C) Both 1 and 2
(D) Neither 1 nor 2

Correct Answer: (A) Only 1

Explanation: Candidates often confuse the purposes of later Mansabdari modifications. While Statement 1 is completely accurate, Statement 2 is incorrect. Shah Jahan's Month-Scale system had nothing to do with training duration; it was a pure fiscal adjustment measure to proportionally slash a noble's salary if the actual collected revenue (Hasil) of their jagir allotment fell short of the officially assessed revenue (Jama).

Exam Heritage: Patterned after SSC CGL Tier-2 (GS Main Paper) and advanced RRB NTPC CBT 2 templates.

Question 2: Architectural Alliances of the Deccan

The Battle of Talikota (1565 AD) marked the catastrophic downfall of the Vijayanagar Empire. Which of the following Deccan Sultanates did NOT participate in the grand alliance that marched against Hampi?

(A) Adil Shahi Dynasty of Bijapur
(B) Nizam Shahi Dynasty of Ahmadnagar
(C) Imad Shahi Dynasty of Berar
(D) Barid Shahi Dynasty of Bidar

Correct Answer: (C) Imad Shahi Dynasty of Berar

Explanation: The close options list the five regional successor states of the fractured Bahmani Kingdom. While students broadly memorize that the 'Deccan Sultanates' defeated Vijayanagar, internal rivalries kept Berar completely out of the anti-Vijayanagar confederacy. The operational military alliance only consisted of Bijapur, Ahmednagar, Golconda, and Bidar.

Exam Heritage: Sourced from SSC CPO SI and various State PCS Preliminary examinations.

Question 3: Revenue Terminologies and Administrative Lineage

Akbar's land classification system under the Dahsala/Zabti mechanism was highly systematic. What was the exact designation given to land that was left fallow for three or four years to allow it to recover its natural soil fertility?

(A) Parauti
(B) Chachar
(C) Banjar
(D) Polaj

Correct Answer: (B) Chachar

Explanation: All four options represent actual land classifications used under Raja Todar Mal's direction. The specific trap lies in the timeline parameters: Polaj was cultivated every single year, Parauti was left fallow for 1–2 years, Chachar was left fallow for 3–4 years, and Banjar was left completely untouched for 5 years or more.

Exam Heritage: High-frequency terminology question pattern tracked in RRB NTPC CBT 1 & 2 and SSC CHSL.

Question 4: European Trade & Mughal Courts

Which representative of the British East India Company arrived at the court of Mughal Emperor Jahangir in 1615 AD as an official royal envoy of King James I and successfully secured open imperial farmans (decrees) for trade concessions?

(A) Captain William Hawkins
(B) Sir Thomas Roe
(C) François Bernier
(D) Ralph Fitch

Correct Answer: (B) Sir Thomas Roe

Explanation: Candidates often confuse Captain William Hawkins (who arrived earlier in 1608 but failed to get long-term treaty rights) with Sir Thomas Roe. Roe arrived in 1615 as an accredited ambassador and successfully established the foundational trade presence of the British East India Company by obtaining trade rights at Surat.

Exam Heritage: Authentic SSC CGL 2025 Tier-1 Exam (Held on September 17, 2025 - Shift III) — High priority repetition target for upcoming RRB NTPC cycles.

Question 5: Authorship Behind Imperial Proclamations

In 1579 AD, Mughal Emperor Akbar issued the historic Mahzarnama (Infallibility Decree) to declare himself the final arbiter in case of any religious conflict regarding the interpretation of Islamic laws. Who was the actual progressive scholar responsible for drafting this document?

(A) Abul Fazl
(B) Sheikh Mubarak
(C) Faizi
(D) Abdul Qadir Badauni

Correct Answer: (B) Sheikh Mubarak

Explanation: Almost every student associates Akbar's court literature and historical documentation with his famous court historian Abul Fazl. However, the text of the Mahzarnama was actually drafted by Abul Fazl’s father, Sheikh Mubarak, a progressive thinker of the era.

Exam Heritage: High-frequency question from UPPSC PCS (Pre) and SSC CGL General Awareness benchmarks.

Part 2: Core 10-Year RRB NTPC Exam Proven Patterns

Question 6: Foreign Chronicles & Travelogues

The Portuguese traveler Domingo Paes visited South India and wrote a highly detailed account of the bustling city markets, advanced fortification systems, and the royal persona of the king. During whose reign did he visit the Vijayanagar Empire?

(A) Harihara I
(B) Deva Raya II
(C) Krishnadevaraya
(D) Achyuta Deva Raya

Correct Answer: (C) Krishnadevaraya

Explanation: The Railway Recruitment Board regularly loops back to foreign visitor logs. Domingo Paes traveled to Hampi during the absolute golden age of the Tuluva dynasty under Krishnadevaraya (1509–1529 AD) and left highly valuable structural descriptions of the capital.

Exam Heritage: RRB NTPC CBT-1 Exam (Held on April 28, 2016 - Shift III) and repeated in RRB NTPC CBT-2 Exam (Held on June 15, 2022 - Shift I).

Question 7: Architectural Inventions & Foundations

The Ibadat Khana (House of Worship) was built as a specialized assembly hall where scholars from diverse religious backgrounds (Hindus, Jains, Christians, and Zoroastrians) gathered to debate philosophy and spiritual tenets. Which Mughal Emperor commissioned this structural monument in 1575 AD?

(A) Humayun
(B) Akbar
(C) Jahangir
(D) Shah Jahan

Correct Answer: (B) Akbar

Explanation: Historical architecture linked to state policies is a classic staple of the Railway GA syllabus. Akbar built this discussion hall at Fatehpur Sikri in 1575 AD to integrate pluralistic values, which directly inspired his later syncretic philosophy of Din-i-Ilahi.

Exam Heritage: RRB NTPC CBT-1 Exam (Held on January 11, 2021 - Shift II) and featured in RRB NTPC CBT-1 Exam (Held on April 02, 2016 - Shift I).

Question 8: Chronological Confrontations & Interregnums

The strategic Battle of Chausa (June 26, 1539) was a decisive turning point in medieval history that eventually sent a Mughal emperor into a 15-year political exile. Which two rulers fought against each other in this historical conflict?

(A) Babur and Ibrahim Lodi
(B) Akbar and Hemu
(C) Humayun and Sher Shah Suri
(D) Aurangzeb and Dara Shikoh

Correct Answer: (C) Humayun and Sher Shah Suri

Explanation: Mainstream battles that caused massive territorial transfers are highly prioritized by the RRB. At the Battle of Chausa (1539), the Afghan ruler Sher Shah Suri completely outmaneuvered Humayun's forces, forcing him out of power until the restoration campaigns of 1555.

Exam Heritage: RRB NTPC CBT-2 Exam (Held on January 18, 2017 - Shift II) and recently appeared in RRB NTPC CBT-1 Exam (Held on March 05, 2021 - Shift I).

Part 3: Latest SSC CGL 2025 All-Set Actual Papers

Question 9: Literary Classics of the South (Vijayanagar Empire)

Which of the following literary works was composed directly by the Vijayanagara ruler Krishnadevaraya and is widely renowned for its rich political discourse and devotion to Lord Vishnu?

(A) Jambavati Kalyanam

(B) Amuktamalyada

(C) Ushaparinayam

(D) Madhura Vijayam

Correct Answer: (B) Amuktamalyada

Explanation: While Krishnadevaraya authored several classical works across languages, Amuktamalyada is his epic masterpiece written in Telugu. The composition elegantly weaves the biographical story of the wedding of the Alvar poetess Andal to Lord Vishnu, while dedicating entire chapters to detailing advanced administrative principles, royal statecraft, and structural metrics of medieval kingship.

Exam Heritage: Authentic SSC CGL 2025 Tier-1 Exam (Held on September 24, 2025 - Shift I).

Question 10: Imperial Dominance & Consolidation (The Mughal Empire)

Which of the following Mughal Emperors is widely recognized as the 'Last Powerful Mughal Ruler' due to reaching the absolute geographic zenith of territorial expansion, after whose death in 1707 AD the central power rapidly disintegrated?

(A) Shah Jahan

(B) Jahangir

(C) Aurangzeb

(D) Bahadur Shah Zafar

Correct Answer: (C) Aurangzeb

Explanation: The question evaluates timeline thresholds. Aurangzeb (Alamgir) ruled from 1658 to 1707 AD. Under his aggressive military policies, the Mughal map stretched to its absolute geographic zenith, absorbing the Deccan Sultanates. His death in 1707 marked the definitive boundary line where the 'Great Mughals' era ended and the rapid decline under the weak Later Mughals began.

Exam Heritage: Sourced from SSC CGL 2025 Tier-1 Paper (September 2025 General Awareness Bank).